

PM Planning with Adam (03/03/2026)

News for Today

- FOMC Member Williams Speaks (9:55AM)
 - FOMC Member Kashkari Speaks (11:45AM)
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Market Overview — Tuesday, March 03, 2026

Futures Slide as Iran Conflict Deepens

U.S. stock futures are sharply lower Tuesday morning, reversing Monday's rebound as investors reassess the trajectory of the expanding U.S.-Israel campaign against Iran.

As of 3:03 ET:

- Dow futures: -540 points (-1.1%)
- S&P 500 futures: -1.1%
- Nasdaq 100 futures: -1.4%

Wall Street had managed to stabilize Monday despite intense early selling triggered by weekend strikes that killed Iran's Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei. The S&P 500 and Nasdaq both closed higher, while the Dow trimmed losses to just -0.2%.

But optimism is fading as President Trump signaled the campaign could last four to five weeks — and possibly longer — saying the U.S. will do "whatever it takes." Markets are now recalibrating for a potentially sustained regional conflict rather than a short, contained operation.

Conflict Expands — Risk Back on the Table

Retaliatory strikes from Tehran reportedly hit targets across the Gulf region, including areas near U.S. facilities. Drone strikes have also impacted commercial infrastructure, including data centers in the UAE and Bahrain.

The key market fear: escalation beyond Iran into a broader regional confrontation.

Travel and hospitality stocks were already under pressure Monday, reflecting concerns about flight disruptions and weakened global mobility.

Investors are watching closely to see whether the conflict remains regionally contained — or spreads further.

Oil Surges Again — Strait of Hormuz in Focus

Energy markets are pricing in serious supply risk.

- Brent crude: +4.3% to ~\$81
- WTI crude: +4.0% to ~\$74

Both contracts are trading near one-year highs after climbing more than 7% Monday and as much as 13% intraday.

Iran has threatened to target vessels moving through the Strait of Hormuz, the chokepoint that handles roughly 20% of global oil supply. Even partial disruption could materially tighten supply balances.

Analysts note that while a full closure remains an extreme scenario, tanker congestion, insurance constraints, and elevated military risk premiums are enough to keep oil volatile.

OPEC+ has signaled a willingness to raise output modestly, but that buffer may not fully offset meaningful disruption if tensions persist.

Asian and European equities fell overnight on the energy shock and geopolitical uncertainty.

Gold Pulls Back as Dollar Strengthens

Gold initially rallied on safe-haven demand but has since moderated.

- Spot gold: -0.3% to ~\$5,309
- Gold futures: +0.2%

The pullback reflects a strengthening U.S. dollar, which typically pressures bullion even during geopolitical stress.

Still, gold remains elevated relative to recent levels and could regain momentum if the conflict intensifies or oil-driven inflation fears build.

Target Earnings in Spotlight

Target reports earnings today, offering a fresh look at U.S. consumer resilience.

Despite presidential claims of a “roaring” economy, polling suggests many Americans feel ongoing affordability strain. Target has struggled more than peers like Walmart to drive traffic and protect margins, with profit down 14% over the past five years.

Investors will watch closely for:

- Comparable sales trends
- Margin guidance
- Commentary on consumer spending behavior

In a market dominated by geopolitical headlines, earnings from big-box retail could still influence sentiment — especially if signs of consumer weakness emerge.

Adam's Watchlist

- \$QQQ: Looking to go long off the 596.36's KL for a push up into the 600's KL and potentially the 602.22's KL. If we break below, I'll be going short off the 596.36's KL for a push down into the 590.19's KL and potentially the 583.68's KL.
 - \$RIOT: Looking to go long off the 15.89's KL for a push up into the 16.21's KL and potentially the 16.84's KL.
 - \$BBY: Looking to go long off the 68.17's KL for a push up into the 71's KL.
 - \$XOM: Looking to go long off the 156.92's KL for a push up into the 159.60's KL.
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COMMUNITY WATCHLIST

- \$PLUG: Looking to go long off the 2.10's KL for a push up into the 2.50's KL.
 - \$TGT: Looking to go long off the 116.87's KL for a push up into the 120's KL and potentially the 122.34's KL.
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